

Italy Trip Overview (May 13–27, 2026)

Route: Rome → Amalfi Coast → Florence → Tuscany → Cinque Terre → Venice

Nights: 2 Rome / 4 Amalfi / 2 Florence / 3 Tuscany / 2 Cinque Terre / 1 Venice

Rome (May 13–15) — Where to Stay

Recommended areas:

- Trastevere (lively evenings, walkable dining)
- Pantheon / Campo de' Fiori (central, flat, easy taxis)

Rome Highlights

May 14: Morning Vatican Museums, Sistine Chapel, St. Peter's Basilica (guided).

Afternoon: Colosseum & Forum OR Capitoline Hill. Evening in Trastevere.

Train: Rome → Naples (May 15)

Depart Roma Termini at 10:20 CET

Frecciarossa 8335 (1h13m)

Arrive Napoli Centrale at 11:33 CET

Amalfi Coast (May 15–19) — Where to Stay

Recommended bases:

- Amalfi town (best ferry access, flatter walking)
- Ravello (quieter, dramatic views, calmer pace)

Amalfi Highlights

Capri day trip, half-day cooking class in Amalfi, one rest day, and one coastal town/ferry-hopping day.

Train: Naples → Florence (May 19)

Depart Napoli Centrale at 12:10 CET
Frecciarossa 9422 (3h01m)
Arrive Firenze Santa Maria Novella at 15:11 CET

Florence (May 19–21) — Where to Stay

Recommended areas:

- Historic Center near Duomo or Santa Croce
- Oltrarno (local feel, quieter nights)

Florence Highlights

Duomo exterior, ONE museum (Accademia or Uffizi), sunset at Piazzale Michelangelo.

Tuscany Countryside (May 21–24) — Where to Stay

Recommended area:

- Val d'Orcia (Pienza, Montepulciano vicinity)
- Ideal for Vespa riding and hot air balloon launches.

Tuscany Highlights

Vespa day (Pienza/Montepulciano), sunrise hot air balloon (weather permitting), hill towns and winery lunches.

Car Return & Transfer (Sunday, May 24)

Drive Val d'Orcia → Pisa Airport (2.5–3 hrs).
Return car at Pisa Airport (open Sundays).
Train Pisa Airport → La Spezia Centrale (~1 hr), then local train into Cinque Terre village.

Cinque Terre (May 24–26) — Where to Stay

Recommended villages:

- Vernazza (most iconic views)
- Monterosso al Mare (easiest walking, beaches)

Cinque Terre Highlights

Village hopping by train, sunset in Manarola, relaxed coastal mornings.

Venice (May 26–27) — Where to Stay

Recommended neighborhoods:

- Dorsoduro (calmer, scenic, close to gondola routes)
- Cannaregio (local vibe, excellent dining)

Venice Highlights

May 26 evening: 8:20pm gondola ride booked.
Cicchetti crawl and evening canal wandering.